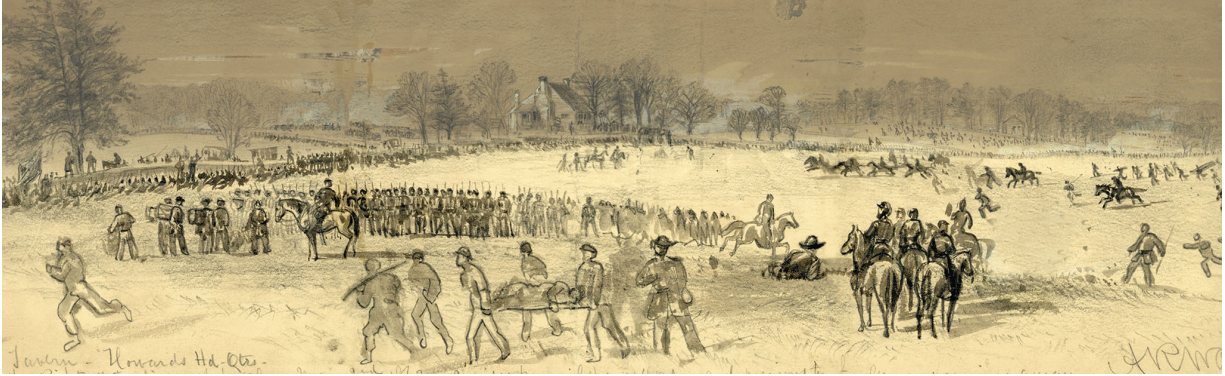




Battle sketch

Civil War artist Alfred Waud made drawings of the conflict for the American press. Here, an injured soldier is stretchered off the Chancellorsville battlefield. General Howard's headquarters at Dowdall's Tavern is nearby.

“At that moment I believed my
commanding general a
whipped man.”

DARIUS COUCH, COMMANDING THE UNION SECOND CORPS, ON
HOOKER'S LOSS OF NERVE, MAY 1, 1863

The “Flying Dutchmen”

Men of Major General Daniel Sickles' Third Corps, stationed on a cleared hill called Hazel Grove just to the west of Chancellorsville, discovered Jackson's flank march not long after it got started. Hooker and Sickles misinterpreted the movement as a Confederate retreat. Eleventh Corps commander, Oliver Otis Howard, stationed on the extreme right of the Union line—exactly where Jackson was headed—also believed the enemy was retreating. Scouts reported the enemy massing in the forest to the right, but Howard dismissed them.

About 5:30pm, with darkness falling, Jackson unleashed 26,000 Confederates, screaming the rebel yell, into the 8,500 men of the Eleventh Corps. There was no time for the Union regiments to realign and react; the only safety was in flight. But further along the